Service Automation - 256 Release

What is coming in 254?

254 Service Automation E2E Demo Script
Figma: https://www.figma.com/design/5G3nzevYkVNvrPzSQVl0go/UX_Service-Automation?node-id=2236-176092&node-type=canvas&t=yJY1JYQmsCEEXrXw-0

Service Request, Cases and Incident

How should we look at Service Requests, Cases and Incidents? What is the interplay between these objects? What is the purpose?

SERVICE REQUEST AND SERVICE REQUEST LINE ITEM

We should move away from Service Request Line. The primary reason for Service Request Line Item is to handle the bundle scenario. However, this can be handled by having a self lookup to Service Request entity itself.

> **Concern**
> The concern in keeping this entity is that when the end user goes to 'My Requests' on the portal, they will see a list of Service Request they have raised. However, to see the actual status of the service request, the user now has to click on a Service Request Line Item record. In cases where we do not have a bundle, the user will still need to click on the Line Item record to see the status or collaborate on the request

Let's take the 'Request for Leave' Service Process. The Service Process is setup to create a Service Request record. In the current approach, to see the status of the request the user will need to go into the Service Request record and click on the Service Request Line Item record. Moving away from Service Request Line will mean that the 'Request for Leave' Service Process will only create the Service Request record.

How does work in a bundle scenario?

Let's take the Employee Onboarding Service Process. This process is built up of multiple Service Processes

- Request for HR Orientation
- Request for Access Card
- Request for Laptop

Each of these Service Process can be requested separately as well and is available in the Catalog. However, the Employee Onboarding Service Process is setup as a bundle with these service processes as options.

Setup Scenario 1

- Employee Onboarding, Request HR Orientation, Request Access Card, Request Laptop are all setup to create Service Request records
- When the user submits the Employee Onboarding request along with other requests, the system will create 4 Service Requests.
- However the Service Request records for HR Orientation, Access Card and Laptop will be tagged with Employee Onboarding as the parent
- In the My Tickets list, the user can only see the Parent Service Request. The Child Service Requests are shown in the detail page of the parent request

Setup Scenario 2

- All the Service Processes are created as Cases
- The system created 4 Cases. Employee Onboarding is the parent case with the other Service Process setup as Child Cases
- The My Tickets list show only the parent cases. The child cases are shown as part of the detailed view of the parent case

Setup Scenario 3

- Employee Onboarding Service Process and Request for Access Card is setup to create a Case
- HR Orientation and Laptop is setup to create a Service Request record
- Once again, on submitting the Employee Onboarding service request the system creates
    - 1 parent case
    - 1 child case to the parent case
    - 2 child service requests to the parent case

SERVICE REQUEST CREATION

As of 254 the architecture is to create the below every time a Service Request is submitted

- Service Request record
- Service Request Line Item record
- Case/Incident record as defined in the Service Process
- Case/Incident is associated with the Service Request Line Item record.

> **Concern**
> The concern is that there are cases where the customer would just want to stop at creating a Service Request record. If this is the case, then we will need show Service Request record on the portal as well. In the current construct when a Service Process is submitted which creates a Case, it also creates a Service Request record. The user will see 2 records - 1 Service Request record and 1 Case record

In 256 we will retain this construct. That is, a Service Request record will always be created when a request is submitted. Depending on the Service Process configuration, we will also create a Case or an Incident. The above concern of duplicate records will need to be managed on the UX and the API layer.

Products and Services

There is a lot of confusion on what a Product is and what a Service Process is? What is a sellable product? What is a sellable Service? Etc. This section is to alleviate some of those questions and concerns.

What is a Product?

- According to **Philip Kotler**, a leading authority in marketing, "A product is anything that can be offered to a market to satisfy a want or need, including physical goods, services, experiences, events, persons, places, properties, organisations, information, and ideas." (Source: Kotler & Keller, *Marketing Management*)
- The American Marketing Association (**AMA**) defines a product as "a bundle of attributes (features, functions, benefits, and uses) capable of exchange or use; usually a mix of tangible and intangible forms." (Source: AMA Dictionary)
- According to **Gartner**, a product is a deliverable that is designed to meet the needs of a target market, which can include both tangible goods and intangible offerings like software. It's part of a broader "product management" framework that focuses on the lifecycle of the product, from ideation to decommissioning.
- **Forrester** sees a product as something that combines a company's capabilities with customer needs to create value. This can be a combination of physical products, digital solutions, and even a blend of productized services. They emphasize the importance of the customer experience in product design.
- **IDC (International Data Corporation)** tends to define a product within the technology context, focusing on both hardware and software that organizations use to enhance business processes or create new digital experiences.
- **McKinsey** defines a product as any offering that meets customer demand, including both tangible and digital solutions. Their focus is on product management, which drives continuous improvement based on feedback loops and innovation cycles.

How does Salesforce define Product?
A **Product** is a tangible or intangible item that a company offers to meet the needs or desires of its customers. Products are typically standardized, can be sold and delivered repeatedly, and are designed to solve a specific problem or fulfill a need. Products can be physical goods, software, or even digital goods like ebooks and apps. There is a typically an ownership transfer when a Product is purchased. Ex: A laptop model sold in stores, A downloadable music album, Off-the-shelf software applications, etc.

What is a Service?

- According to **Zeithaml, Bitner, and Gremler**, experts in service marketing, "Services are deeds, processes, and performances provided or co-produced by one entity or person for another entity or person." (Source: Zeithaml, Bitner, Gremler, Services Marketing)
- The International Organisation for Standardisation (**ISO**) describes a service as "the result of at least one activity necessarily performed at the interface between the supplier and customer, which is generally intangible." (Source: ISO 9000:2015)
- **Gartner** defines a service as "a repeatable activity that a provider makes available to customers to create value." This can include managed services, cloud services, or IT services, which are often delivered continuously and supported by a service-level agreement (SLA)
- **Forrester** emphasizes service as part of the customer journey. Services can be standalone or part of a broader product offering, often aimed at improving customer engagement or delivering a desired outcome. The focus is on personalised, customer-centric service delivery.
- **McKinsey** sees services as any activity that delivers ongoing value to customers, typically through personalized engagement or recurring support. They emphasize that services can create lasting relationships with customers by delivering outcomes, not just products.

How does Salesforce define Services?
A **Service** is a non-tangible action or set of actions that a company offers to fulfill a customer's need. Services are often personalized and are consumed at the time they are delivered, meaning they can't be owned or stored for later use. Services usually involve some level of interaction between the provider and the customer and are often dependent on the provider's skills and expertise. Ex: Dispute Management, Reset Password, Office Wifi not Working, Update Benefits, etc

Nuances to Products and Services

When do you model something as a Product and when do you model them as a Service. This is a representative list.

Items	Modelled As	Description	Examples
Hardware Products	Product	Physical goods, devices, and machines used in business operations.	Dell PowerEdge Server, Juniper Network Routers, Siemens CNC Machine etc
Software Products	Product	Standalone software applications or platforms that businesses use.	Workday, Salesforce, Slack etc
Subscription Products	Product	Products or services delivered via recurring payments, often as SaaS or cloud-based offerings.	Netflix, Hubspot, AWS, Coursera etc
Productised Services	Product	These are services that are productised and sold like products. Typically standardised with a set price and scope, making them easier to market, sell and deliver. Productised Services fit a unique space, combining elements of both traditional services and products, providing businesses with a more scalable, repeatable, and often cost-effective way to deliver professional services.	Website Design Packages, Marketing Campaign Packages, Managed IT Services etc
Digital Products	Product	Electronic products, often downloadable or accessible online	E-books, online couses etc
Consumables	Product	Items that are used in operations and need to be replenished regularly	Office supplices, cleaning products etc
Maintenance and Support Contracts	Product	Ongoing service agreement to maintain or support a product after purchase	Extended warranties, annual maintenance contract etc
Financial Products	Product	Products from financial institutions for business operations	Loans, Insurance etc.
Installation Services	Service	Processes focussed on setting up hardware, software or equipments	Software installation, Equipment installation, IT Network installation etc
Maintenance and Support Services	Service	Processes that involve ongoing upkeep and support of products or systems	Server Monitoring, Server Repair, Software upgrade, systems check etc
Customer Service	Service	Processes focussed on resolving customer queries	Replace card, password reset, office location, account access
Financial Services	Service	Financial process that customer can request for specific needs	Address Update, Fee Reversal, Compliant Management , Dispute Management, Order Checkbook, Replace Cards , Manage Beneficiaries
Automotive	Service	Processes that involve enabling/disabling features on the vehicle as well as personalisation services including car finance.	Remote Actions for Connected Vehicle like Remote Disable Vehicle, Remote Door Lock Title Change, Lease Extension, Payment Deferral, Address Update, Loan Statement, Service Appointment Booking
Employee Service	Service		Onboarding, Add Beneficiaries • Add Dependents Payroll Issue • Expense Issue • Benefits, Employment proof request, PTO Requests
ITSM	Service		Wifi Access point reset, Reset Access Card, Order Laptop, Order Transportation card
Field Service	Service		Equipment installation, Preventive maintenance, Emergency Repairs, Training Requests

Commercial vs Non Commercial Products and Services

In many industries, not all products that are created or modelled are available for direct sale. These products are divided into two categories:

- Commercial Products – These are sellable products that are made available to customers. They are the final offerings that businesses market, sell, and support. These are what customers directly interact with and pay for.

- Non-Commercial Products – These are technical components or internal systems that are not directly sold to customers but are crucial in creating or supporting the final commercial products. They are often sub-components or internal tools that work together to enable the commercial product to function.

Example, iPhone is the commercial product which is made up of non commercial products such as the A-Series Chip, iOS, Qualcomm 5G Modem, Battery, Camera, Sensors etc.

From a fulfilment perspective, when the commercial product is purchased by the customer an order is created for that product. This order fulfilment then decomposes the commercial products to its individual component products and orchestrates the fulfilment for each product. We use **Dynamic Revenue Orchestrator** for this.

A similar construct is needed for Services as well. Please see Service Automation and DRO for information on this.

Products in ITSM (SC)

In ITIL, products refer to tangible or intangible items created or managed by an organisation to deliver value to customers as part of IT services. While ITIL is more service focused, products play an essential supporting role in the framework by acting as the components or tools that enable services. Product in ITIL can include Hardware products, Software Product, Platform and Infrastructure products, etc.

Products in ITIL are also considered as Configuration Items when tracked in a CMDB. CIs help manage, track, and monitor product usage, configurations, and relations within the IT environment.

Typically, when we think about products, we envision a straightforward purchase flow where a user buys a product, an order is generated, and a series of steps follow to fulfil that order. This often involves processing payments, managing delivery logistics, and providing post-purchase support. However, in the realm on IT Service Management, the concept of “order” doesn’t quite fit the same way. Instead, the flow is more service-centric and designed around requests rather than transactions.

In ITSM, products are often managed as services or assets rather than as orders, and the process centers on fulfilling the service request. Here’s how the flow generally works:

- **User Request:** The process begins when a user submits a request for a product - such as a laptop, software, or other IT assets - through the portal or catalog. This isn’t a purchase: it’s a request that typically does not involve direct payment by the user, especially within organisations where IT resources are centrally managed.
- **Request Assignment and Fulfilment:** Once the request is logged, it’s assigned to an IT team responsible for managing inventory or procuring the item. If the product is available in the inventory, the IT team will reserve and assign it to the user. If not, they may need to initiate procurement with a vendor, following any organisational policies for approvals and sourcing.
- **Configuration and Setup:** After the product is acquired, the IT team prepares it according to the user’s needs and organisational standards. This step may involve:
    - Installing necessary software
    - Configuring security settings
    - Ensuring compliance with IT policies
    - Testing the product of functionality
- **Delivery and Assignment to User:** Once the product is fully configure, it’s assigned or delivered to the user, often accompanied by setup assistance, usage guidance, and support contact information.
- **Tracking and Lifecycle Management:** Unlike typical product orders that end at delivery, in ITSM, products (often treated as Configuration Items, or CIs) are continuously managed, The IT team tracks the product in the the CMDB, monitoring its usage, configuration, maintenance history, and eventual replacement or disposal. This lifecycle approach

supports asset management and ensures the product continues to support the user and organisation effectively

- **Support and Maintenance:** Post-assignment, users can submit support requests or incidents if they encounter issues, with IT support teams handling troubleshooting, repairs, or replacements as needed. This support is part of the service-oriented approach of ITSM, where the focus is on sustaining the user's productivity and satisfaction rather than simply fulfilling a one-time purchase.

This flow differs significantly from traditional order fulfilment because it's not about one-off transactions but about ongoing service delivery and asset management. In ITSM, every product-related request is part of a larger ecosystem designed to support the organisation's operational efficiency, compliance, and security standards, and ultimately to ensure that users have the tools they need to be productive.

To enable service requests for products within an ITSM environment, we can consider 2 primary approaches, each with distinct advantages and limitations. Here's a detailed look at how each approach would work, focussing on how products can be configured, requested and fulfilled within the ITSM framework.

APPROACH 1

In this approach, we configure products as Product2 records as part of PCM. A global flag is set that designates all products to be handled as service requests rather that typical product orders. The global flag also specify whether product requests are created as a Case or an Incident.

- Catalog Interaction: When the user browses the catalog, instead of being able to add products to a cart (as they might in a standard flow), clicking on a product opens a Product Configuration page. This page allows the user to configure aspects of the product they need, tailoring the product product to their requirements. For example if the user is requesting a laptop, they could choose from options like memory capacity (ex. 16 GB RAM) or storage options.
- User Configuration Options: The configuration page allows for a streamlined, self-service experience where users can customise product attributes to match their requirements without needing to submit multiple requests for different configurations.
- Drawbacks and Limitations
    - Since this approach treats products as standalone service requests without integration with ITSM service processes, the full set of ITSM service features does not apply to these requests. For ex:
        - Knowledge Articles association
        - There is limited functionality for defining whether the product request will create a Case or an Incident automatically.
        - Fulfilment process for the product request is managed separately

This approach works well if the goal is to quickly enable product requests with a straightforward configuration capability but may be limiting for organisations that need a richer service process experience or require complex workflows associated with product requests

APPROACH 2

In this approach, the Service Process Designer allows for a more comprehensive configuration experience by integration products as part of the broader service processes, providing a fully customisable flow for the user

- Products: Product are still created a Product2 records. It can be priced and eligibility rules defined on it
- Product Association in Service Process Design: When creating a service process (ex. Request a laptop), the designer has the option to associate specific products or entire product families with the process. This gives service designers the flexibility to offer users a curated list of products based on what's available or relevant for specific use cases
    - Product Selection Options: The designer can either
        - Select Individual Products

        - Select a Product Family
        - Select Product Set
- Service Process Features that are available
    - Knowledge Article association
    - Case or Incident creation setup
    - Fulfilment process setup
- Runtime Experience for Users:
    - Automated First Screen with Product Options: When users initiate a request, the first screen presents a list of products available, filtered by eligibility rules.
    - Configuration: Once the user selects a product they are taken to the configuration page where they can adjust specifications (ex. choosing RAM)

While it requires more configuration effort at the outset, this approach is more service-oriented, gives flexibility, allows a guided flow for product selection and makes it valuable for the organisations focused on user support and lifecycle management of IT assets

Bundles (SC)

Service bundles simply the process of requesting related services by grouping them into a single package. This approach allows users to request multiple services simultaneously, creating a seamless experience. Similar to product bundling in commerce, where items are grouped to enhance the purchasing experience, service bundles group related offerings for improved efficiency and convenience. However, directly combining products and service within the same bundle can be challenging due to fundamental differences in how users engage with each.

WHAT IS SERVICE BUNDLING?

In a service bundle, users can select a group of services that fulfill a cohesive goal. For instance, a new employee bundle might include account setup, software installation, and training. Instead of requesting each service individually, users complete the intake for the services together which allows the service team to fulfil these requests in a coordinated manner.

WHY DIRECTLY BUNDLING SELLABLE PRODUCTS AND SERVICES IS COMPLEX?

The fundamental differences between service requests and sellable product workflows make it difficult to bundle products directly with service requests. Product purchases follow a traditional commerce experience where user add items to a cart, configure them, place an order. Conversely, service request involved filling out the intake and submitting them for processing without the need for checkout steps.

- Sellable Product Flow: Users typically add products to a cart, configure them, review pricing and place an order
- Service Request flow: Users initiate a service request by filling out an intake form that captures the necessary details, which is then processed and fulfilled.

This difference in experience makes is less practical to combine sellable products and services within the same bundle, as each type of request follows a distinct interaction model

SCENARIOS WHERE PRODUCTS AND SERVICES INTERSECT

While direct bundling isn't always feasible, there are instances where products and services are related or support each other in service delivery:

- ITSM
    - In ITSM, products are treated as Service Requests, where each product or a group of products in presented as a

request in a catalog. This is often done when the user experience is designed to treat products as services, allowing users to initiate requests for items directly as part of a service process
    - Example Use Case: A bundled package for remote work could include a laptop, headset, and monitor. In this case, each product is requested as a service item, so that the user can select the entire bundle and each item is managed as part of a coordinated service delivery
- Service Fulfilment that requires Consumables
    - There are cases where a service request might require products or consumables for completion, though the user is not directly requesting the product. The product may be sourced and provided by the service team as part of fulfilling the request. This is common in maintenance or support scenarios
    - Example: For a maintenance request, a technician might identify that a replacement part is needed. The technician could collaborate with the customer to submit a separate order for the part, which is then used to complete the service request.

DESIGN TIME EXPERIENCE

The Service Process Designer will provide an intuitive user experience for designers to build service bundles that include multiple related services under the a unified process. To create a bundle, the designer navigates to the Bundle section with the designer interface, where they can assemble individual service processes that are logically grouped together. The bundling experience closely mirrors the familiar PCM capability but with a key distinction - the designer can only select other service processes for inclusion in the bundle, as sellable products are excluded from service bundles.

Key Design Features:

- Selection of Service Processes: Designers can add related service processes to the bundle by choosing from a list of available services. For example, while designing an Employee Onboarding bundle, the designer might include processes like HR Orientation Request, Access Card Request and Laptop Request.
- Configuring Mandatory and Optional Services: When adding service processes to the bundle, the designer has the option to set each process as mandatory or optional.
    - Mandatory Service Process: These are services that users must complete as part of the bundle. If marked mandatory, users will be required to fill out the associated intake form before submitting the entire bundle. For instance, the HR Orientation Request might be set as mandatory within the Employee Onboarding bundle
    - Optional Service Processes: These are services users can complete at their discretion. Users are presented with these options during the submission but are not required to complete them. This flexibility is useful in bundles where certain items, like an Access Card Request, might not be essential for all users

RUNTIME EXPERIENCE

When users log into the service portal, they can browse and search for bundled service offerings relevant to their needs. Upon finding a bundle, users can launch the entire service request process, which presents a clear, organized layout for submitting multiple requests at one.

Let’s use the Employee Onboarding example to illustrate the runtime experience:

- Locating and Initiating the Bundle: the user finds the Employee Onboarding bundle in the service catalog and selects it. This bundle is designed to simply onboarding by grouping necessary services like HR Orientation, Access Card Request, and Laptop Request into a single, unified process.
- Tab-Based Interface: When the user opens the bundle, the interface presents each service process as a separate tab within the main bundle view. This layout allows the user to see each service in isolation and fill out specific details without switching contexts
    - Mandatory Services: Any mandatory service processes are prominently marked, and users must complete these forms to move forward

    - Optional Services: Optional service processes are also displayed, giving the users the flexibility to include them or leave them unselected.
- Bundle Submission: Once the user completes each tab, they have the option to submit the entire bundle with all the associated service requests simultaneously. This consolidated submission approach ensure that related requests are processed together, reducing redundant steps for the user and making it easier for service teams to track the fulfilment

RECORDS CREATED BY THE SERVICE BUNDLE AND ITS COMPONENTS

When a user submits a service bundle, the system creates records for both the main bundle and its associated services. This provides a structured and organised way to track the bundle as a whole, as well as each individual service request with it.

- Parent record for the Bundle: Based on the configuration set by the service designer, the parent bundle request (Employee Onboarding) can create a Case of an Incident to represent the main request. The parent record acts as a central reference point for the entire budnle, enabling service teams to manage the onboarding process as a cohesive unit
- Individual Records for Bundled Services: Each service process within the bundle - such as HR Orientation, Access Card and Laptop Requests - creates its own individual case or incident record. These records maintain their specific details, statuses, and histories independently, which is important for tracking the fulfilment.
- Linking to Parent Record: Each case or incident created for the bundled services includes a reference to the parent bundle record. This parent-child relationship ensures that all associated services are linked to the overarching bundle request. This linkage provides service agents with visibility into which services are part of the overall onboarding process, making it easier to resolve dependencies, track progress and provide timely updates.

~~Pricing~~

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Preview (SC)

Enhancing design time visualization for intake and fulfilment
In Service Automation, preview functionality allows designers to see both intake form previews and fulfilment process previews at the design stage. This capability ensure that designers have a clear understanding of how the forms and processes will appear to end users and agents, allowing for efficient adjustments and more intuitive designs.

INTAKE FORM PREVIEW

The intake form preview offers designers a real-time or static preview of the form layout, allowing them to visualise how end users will experience the form. This is critical for ensuring that the form is intuitive, visually appealing, and aligned with the service's intended goals

- Real-time Render: Whether using screen flows or Omniscripts, the preview functionality allows designers to see the form's fields, prompts, and interactive elements as they would appear to the user. This real-time rendering helps in assessing the layout, navigation and ease of use
- Adjustments: By previewing the form, designers can identify potential usability issues and make adjustments to the layout, such as reordering the fields, refining instructions, or optimising the visual design. For instance, if a form required multiple steps, the designer can ensure that navigation between the sections is clear and smooth
- Screenshot or Static preview Option: Designers can take screenshots of the form or use static previews as reference points to share with stakeholders or to test specific layout adjustments. This is particularly useful when designing complex forms with conditional logic or multiple paths that affect the user's journey

Ex: For an employee onboarding service, the intake form preview allows the designer to test various fields like personal details, department, and equipment selection ensuring the flow is intuitive and streamlined.

Service requests for Product: The idea to automatically show an intake form that lists the different products available as part of the service and on selecting the product we show the configuration screen. This also needs to be available as preview at the design time so designers know exactly what is presented to the user.

FULFILLMENT PROCESS PREVIEW

At the fulfillment level, a preview of the fulfillment process offers designers a high-level visual of the journey from request submission to service delivery. This preview is especially beneficial for complex fulfillment workflows, as it gives designers a detailed view of each stage and the dependencies involved

- Visual Representation: Designers can view the entire fulfillment flow in a visual format, such as a flow diagram. This representation is helpful for understanding how the service request will be fulfilled, including all critical steps and decision points. Whether using Flow, Flow Orchestrator, Stage Management, DRO, the preview enables designers to see each step of the process
- The fulfillment previews allows the designers to identify potential bottlenecks, inefficiencies, or points of confusion within the process. For instance, they may see that too many steps are concentrated in one area or the additional checks are needed in another.

Templates (PCM)

Service Process Templates are comprehensive, pre-built service processes provided by Salesforce or Partners. These templates offer a ready-made framework for common service workflows, enabling customers to quickly implement service processes with minimal customization. Each template includes all necessary components of a complete service process, including intake, fulfilment, and other related elements providing customers with a plug-and-play solution to address frequent service needs.

ACCESSING AND USING SERVICE PROCESS TEMPLATES

Customers can access Service Process Templates directly within the Salesforce platform or through partner-provided libraries.

- Browsing Available Templates: Customer can navigate to the Service Process Templates library in the new Enterprise Catalog Management app and browse a list of templates provided by Salesforce or Partners. Templates will be categorized by industry.
- Reviewing Template Details: Once a template is selected, customers can explore its components in details. This includes viewing the structure of intake forms, examining the fulfillment process flow and reviewing other elements of the service definition. This transparency helps customers understand the end-to-end process and assess if the template align with their needs
- Adopting the Template: If satisfied, customers can simple adopt the template by selecting an option to create a new service process based on the template. This action generates a fully functioning service process, ready for use and can be customised
- Customising the Template: Although templates are ready-to-use, once the are create a Service Processes customers have full control to customise them further as needed.

COMPONENTS OF A SERVICE PROCESS TEMPLATE AND DEPENDENCIES

Here are the components of a Service Process Template and its dependencies:

- Context Definition
- Service Definition
- Service Attributes
- Intake (OmniScript/ScreenFlow/Conversational Experience)

- Fulfilment (Flow/Flow Orchestration/Stage Management/DRO)
- Knowledge Articles
- Eligibility Rules
- Bundles
- Products and its association with Service
- Pricing and its associations
- Catalog and Category

BENEFITS OF SERVICE PROCESS TEMPLATE

User Service process Templates offers several strategic advantages for organisations:

- Rapid Deployment
- Consistency and Quality
- Reduced Development Costs
- Easy Customisation

Packaging (PCM)

Packaging is a critical capability in managing service process and products within Salesforce, enabling seamless transfer of these elements across different environments - such as from sandbox to production. While customers can create and customise products and service within a specific environment, they often need to replicate these configurations across multiple environments to support development, testing, and deployment.

- Consistent deployment across environments: Packaging enables configurations to be replicated across environments, ensuring consistency in how services and products function. This reduces the risk of discrepancies and errors, provide a stable foundation for deployment
- Efficient management of dependences: Service processes and products often have interconnected dependencies that must be preserved when transferring to another environment. Packaging ensures that all required data and metadata, including configurations, custom attributes, and associated records, are moved together, preventing broken links or incomplete setup
- Simplified Testing: By creating packages that encompass the entire service or product configuration, teams can more easily test configurations in sandbox environments and replicate them in production without needed to reconfigure setting.

COMPONENTS OF A SERVICE PROCESS PACKAGE AND DEPENDENCIES

Here are the components of a Service Process Package and its dependencies:

- Context Definition
- Service Definition
- Service Attributes
- Intake (OmniScript/ScreenFlow/Conversational Experience)
- Fulfilment (Flow/Flow Orchestration/Stage Management/DRO)
- Knowledge Articles
- Eligibility Rules
- Bundles
- Products and its association with Service

- Pricing and its associations
- Catalog and Category

PACKAGE LIFECYCLE

The packaging process includes a well-defined lifecycle that encompasses creations, transfer, and unpacking of the package to ensure smooth deployment.

- Package Creation:
  - Selection of Elements: The customer selects the primary service or product record (a Product2 record) and selects to package it. All the related dependencies are automatically identified and presented to the user to ensure everything is in order.
  - Validation: Once elements are identified, validation is conducted to ensure that all necessary components are included and that the package will function correctly once deployed. The packaging process is initiated.
- Transfer Between Environments: There are 2 approaches
  - One approach is - the packaged service or product can be exported from sandbox and imported into the production environment. During this step, all components are preserved as a single cohesive unit, minimising manual configuration and ensuring consistency.
  - The other approach is that the packages are stored in a common location to both Sandbox and Production. Once the package is created in sandbox, it is automatically available for the production environment to use it. No need to manually export and import it
- Unpacking
  - Extraction of Components: The package is unpacked, and each component is deployed in the target environment. The package's dependencies, configurations, and settings are applied as defined during packaging.
  - Final Validation: A final round of validation checks in conducted to ensure that the service or product performs identically to the sandbox environment. Any final adjustments can be made here if necessary

Conversational Experience (ISE)

Service Automation - Gen AI (draft)

Fulfilment and Explainability (FSC)

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Service Invocation for Agents (ISE)

Qualification Rules (PCM)

Qualification Rules are used to determine eligibility criteria for products and services, creating a streamlined approach to manage who can access or user specific items. The setup and execution of qualification rules involves a defined sequence of configurations beginning with a dedicated storage object and ending with rule evaluation based on decision tables and procedures.

CURRENT SETUP OF QUALIFICATION RULES

- Storing rule data in sObject

    - The qualification rule setup begins with an sObject (standard or custom) that stores all the rule data. In PCM, 2 specific sObjects - Product Qualification and Product Disqualification - are commonly used for this purpose, These sObjects store data about eligibility criteria for various products
    - The sObjects contains fields that range across Account, Product, Order, Asset etc. This flexibility allows for setting up detailed rules based on customer, product or even specific asset requirements
- Defining Decision Tables for Rule Columns
    - A decision table is then created to manager specific columns on the sObject representing various conditions (e.g account status, order type) and associated operators (e.g equals, greater than). The decision table functions as a lookup structure that evaluates rules conditions, allowing administrators to assign values that act as rules for qualification
    - Each column represents a condition and is linked to the fields on the sObject. For example a decision table might include conditions like Account Status is Active or Product Category is Premium.
- Rule Creation
    - Once the decision table is in place, administrators can create qualification rules by defining values for each condition as outlined in the decision table columns,. These values specify criteria that a product or account must meet to qualify or disqualify.
    - The completed rules are then written to the source object, populating it with the necessary data that will later be reference during rule evaluation
- Rule Procedures
    - A rule procedure is required to define how the rule will be executed, including the data points (from the customer, product, or context) that the rule wil check. For ex, a rule procedure may specify that when an order is created, the system should check against the qualification rules to ensure that the account meets all eligibility criteria

SETUP EXPERIENCE

CURRENT USER FLOW FOR CREATING QUALIFICATION RULES

[Attach video]

RUNNING QUALIFICATION RULES

- After defining rules and entering records in the sObject, the decision table is refreshed to cache the latest rule data, ensuring that any recent updates are taken into account during rule validation. Caching improves performance, allowing the system to quickly retrieve rules without querying the database each time
- During runtime, the system executes the rule procedure, comparing the relevant data from the user or transaction context against the qualification criteria stored in the sObject. If all specified conditions are met, the product or service is qualified/disqualified for the user according to the definition.

COMMON ELIGIBILITY RULES FOR SERVICE PROCESSES

Here is a list of common rules that are applied of service processes.

- Based on User Role: Rules defined on roles such as Employee, Manager, HR Admin etc
- Based on User Profile: Rules defined on User Profile such as System Administrator etc.
- Based on User Group: Rules defined in User Group. Certain services are available to users in a specific group only
- Based on Department: Service are restricted to users belonging to particular departments or groups within the organisation
- Based on Location: Based on user’s geographical location, ensuring that only users in certain regions can access specific services

- Based on Employment Status: Service may be available only to active employees, while contrators or intern might have limited access
- Based on User Type: Internal and External users (guests have access to limited services)
- Based on Person Account, Account, Contact field
- Based on Assets: Services are eligible only if active assets are available

ELIGIBILITY RULES SCOPE

Eligibility rules play a crucial role in determining which users or accounts are eligible to access specific products and services. In a flexible Service or Product Catalog, these rules can be scoped across multiple levels to provide more granular control over availability, visibility, and access. The different scopes are:

- Catalog Level Eligibility Rules
  - Eligibility rules at the catalog level determine which users or groups of users can access an entire catalog of products or services. This scope is typically broader and focusses on granting or restricting access to large groups of items
  - Catalog level eligibility is useful when different business units or departments within an organisation require specific catalog. Ex, an organisation might have a dedicated catalog for HR-related services, accessible only to HR team members
- Category Level Eligibility Rules
  - Category Level Eligibility rules control access to specific categories within a catalog. Categories are often used to organise products and services by type, function
  - These rules are beneficial when certain department, roles, or regions need access to only specific categories. Ex. only IT staff might need access to a 'Technical Equipment' category
- Catalog Item Eligibility Rules
  - Eligibility at the catalog item level applies directly to individual products or services, enabling the most granular level of control. These rules determine whether a specific user to group of users can access a particular product or service within the a catalog
  - Item-level eligibility rules are helpful when certain products or services are exclusing to specific users, roles, or teams such as premium offerings only available to VIP customers
- Product2 Eligibility Rules
  - Product2 eligibility rules apply based on fields on Product2 such as Type or Family.

BENEFITS OF MULTI-LEVEL ELIGIBILITY RULE SCOPING

- Granular Access Control: Scoping eligibility rules across multiple levels (Catalog, Category, Item, Product Type, and Product Family) allows for fine-grained access control, ensuring users only see items relevant to their role, department, or status.
- Improved User Experience: By targeting eligibility rules precisely, users are presented with only the options they are authorised to request, streamlining their experience and minimising confusion.
- Efficient Administration: Designers can apply eligibility rules where they are most effective, whether on a broad catalog level or down to a specific item, optimising time and resources in rule management.
- Scalable Policy Application: Organisations can define eligibility rules that scale with their growth, applying high-level rules across multiple catalogs or categories while still maintaining control over individual items and product families.

SIMPLIFYING THE QUALIFICATION AND DISQUALIFICATION EXPERIENCE

To streamline the experience of setting up eligibility rules across different levels (Catalog, Category, Catalog Item, Product2), a comprehensive approach involving standardised tools, pre-built objects, and configurable options is essential. Below is a view

of how this simplified setup works, the user experience across different scopes, and how rule inheritance is expected to work.

- OOB sObject for Qualification and Disqualification Rules:
  - We provide standard sObjects (such as Product Qualification and Disqualification) to store the rule data. These OOB sObjects are designed with key fields and relationships necessary for eligibility rules and can be customised to handle additional data as needed
  - With minor modifications, these sObjects can be adapted to support unique requirements, enabling organisation to extend standard rules without the need for extensive custom development
- Decision Table and Rule Procedures
  - A predefined Decision Table is shipped with rule conditions that cover the most common eligibility scenarios. This DT provides a centralised setup for qualifying and disqualifying rules and is bundled with an OOB rule procedure.
  - Separate DTs for qualification and disqualification rules allow administrators to create rules for both inclusing and exclusion
- Setup configuration
  - Through the configuration in Setup, Administrators can select the appropriate Decision Table for eligibility rules based on the organisation's needs. THE DT setup allows Service Designers to manage complex rule conditions without extensive technical knowledge
  - The setup supports two DTs for different rule types (qualification and disqualification) and can be adjusted to align with specific service or product eligibility requirements

User Experience Across Different Scopes

The enhance usability, the interface adapts based on the scope level where eligibility rules are being applied (Catalog, Category, Item. Product2). This consistency simplifies the experience regardless of the scope

- Rule Creation Page
  - Whether setting rules at a catalog, category, item or product level the user is presented with a single, intuitive interface to create the rules
  - Upon entering this page, the user can specify whether they are creating a qualification or disqualification rule. The UI then auto-populates the conditions from the respective DT (as configured in setup), including Product ID which links directly to the corresponding product2 record for the specific service or product
  - For catalog or category level, additional fields specific to those scopes are auto-populated to minimize manual entry
  - Conditions are pre-defined based on the selected DT. Users can populate the values for each condition and save the rule
  - Upon saving, the DT is refreshed to update the cache
- Extensibility
  - If the user requires a field not included in the Decision Table, they are prompted to coordinate with their system administrator. This ensures that any additional fields are added in an organised manner to the DT, allowing controlled expansion without complicating the rule structure.

Inheritance model for eligibility rules

A well-defined inheritance model simplifies eligibility rule application by allows rules to cascade naturally based on the scope, eliminating repetitive entries.

- Catalog-Level Rules:
  - Rules defined as this level and automatically inherited by all categories and items within the catalog. Ex. if the catalog is designated for a specific user group, the rule automatically applies to every item within it

    - Users working at a lower level can view the catalog-level rules in a read-only format, providing visibility into the higher-level access requirements without needed to duplicate them
- Category-Level Rules:
    - Rules created at the category level apply to the items within that category and do not to the broader catalog.
    - Users working at a lower level can view the catalog-level rules in a read-only format, providing visibility into the higher-level access requirements without needed to duplicate them
- Product2 level
    - Eligibility rules at the Product Type or Family level apply to all products and services associated with that particular type or family. This structure provides a way to handle broad eligibility requirements for related groups of items.
- Item-Level Rules
    - Item-level rules are most specific, applying solely to individual products or services. These rules may override category or catalog rules if a more specific restriction or permission is required
    - The user interface at this level displays inherited rules from catalog, category, and Product Type or Family levels in a read-only format, so users can see the comprehensive set of eligibility criteria without redundancy.

Launch Service From Knowledge Articles (FSC)

Self Service and Agent Experience (ISE)

BROWSE EXPERIENCE

Browse experience enhances user navigation by organizing information into categories, providing an intuitive alternative to traditional search functions. It allows customers and agents to efficiently explore and discover relevant processes without needing exact search terms. This approach improves content discoverability and supports both self-service and agent experience
Browse experience in Catalog is enabled by a component named as Product List Page which requires following enhancements in order to support unified catalog:

- Ability to launch services and order products from catalog as the catalog can contain both products as services (dynamically present options for launch or addition to order based on the Product2 type)
    - For customers, the starting point is the self-service component, while for agents, it begins with the 'Browse Catalog' feature
        - Services require a launch experience for completing the intake process
        - Products would need a typical ordering experience where a product can be configured according to needs and added to an order
- Ability to show only products when the browsing is happening in the context of an order
    - Users have the option to first create an order and then access the browse component within the context of that order (applicable to both self service and agent experience)
    - PLP component should hide services within the catalog and only display products in this scenario

ACTION LAUNCHER (UNIFIED CATALOG SUPPORT)

The Action launcher integration with catalog allows the customers and agents to perform the typeahead searches and invoke specific actions. It also enables users to view the categories and filter results based on the category selection.
Action.
With the introduction of new Unified Catalog, it is crucial to address and adapt the admin and run time for the new catalog to ensure seamless discovery and invocation of catalog items

- The following scenarios should be taken into consideration for the new catalog (introduction of new apis will require changes in the technical behaviour)
    - Ability to define the catalog and rule set in the admin experience (this is the current experience)
    - Ability to present eligible results based on defined catalog and rules for the action launcher instance
    - Ability to launch launch an item
- The launch experience within Action Launch will also undergo changes, as the catalog can now include both products and services
    - While executing the launch, it is important to determine whether Product2 is a “product” or a “service”
    - If its of type “service”, then associated intake process can be launched
    - However, if its a “product”, then the user ideally intends to follow an ordering experience (approach to be concluded)
        - Option 1 : Launching the browsing component for the pre-specified catalog during design time allows users to configure the product and proceed with order creation
            - Users follow a similar journey by browsing the catalog, selecting a catalog, and then configuring a product (agent experience)
            - Con : For self-service, the PLP will already be integrated into the page, which implies that users simply need to navigate to the page with the configured catalog (however, catalog experience for action launcher in not available in self service as of now)
        - Option 2 : Allow the creation of a new order or the selection of an existing order as part of the product invocation (i.e. on the click of an item, let user go through order creation or order selection steps as a file based flow & then launch the browse component), ensuring that the browsing experience always occurs within the context of an order
            - Con : If multiple items are to be added in a single order, doing it with browse component by selecting/configuring them appears a simple and a better approach
            - With Action Launcher, to add multiple items to an order (created with first launch) users will have to come back to action launcher and select the previously created order which is not a great experience. Selecting all items at once or creating an order and then adding more items seems to provide a better experience (which is option #1)
            - Same issues is relevant for self service experience (however, catalog experience for action launcher in not available in self service as of now)
        - Option 3 : Do not show products within action launcher experience

ACTION LAUNCHER (CONTEXTUAL RECOMMENDATIONS)

Assistive Actions capability, powered by Gen AI, suggests actions based on the purpose of the conversation by accurately identifying the intent and then offering recommended actions.
The feature currently has hardcoded prompt template for AI based recommendations, limited to conversation details in voice and messaging sessions. This restriction prevents its usage on other pages for e.g. case, incident etc., where contextual recommendations could be useful.

Example : A case or an incident is created with subject as VPN Login Issues

- Recommended action/s from catalog :
    - Certificate Update
    - Network Reconfiguration
    - Software Patch

    - ...

The goal is to make it generic allowing its usage on other record pages. Following aspects should be taken into account :

- Ability to configure a prompt as design-time attribute for the action launcher instance allowing admins to incorporate grounding logic in prompt template using flow, apex etc.
    - Several combinations are possible :
        - Standard app
            - Starts with context object and build the grounding logic based on the data model relationships
        - Console app
            - Scenario 1
                - Parent tab : “Voice Call” or “Messaging Session”
                - Recommendations On : “Account”
                - Grounding Based on : “Voice Call” or “Messaging Session” - “Conversation Entries”
                - E.g. Voice call session for ‘tier update’ issue (grounding based on parent in console)
            - Scenario 2
                - Parent tab : “Case”
                - Recommendations On : “Account”
                - Grounding Based on : Case Data such as “Subject” & “Description”
                - E.g. Email related to change in particulars such as ‘surname change’ (a case is created first and agent navigates to account which makes case page as the parent page)
            - Scenario 1 and Scenario 2 present recommendations on the same object, but with different parent objects, meaning the context or basis is different. This can potentially be handled in flow logic within prompt template, using different logic for each branch based on the object type specified passed in the contract
            - Scenario 3 (recommendations directly on Case page)
                - Parent tab : “No parent page”, only case page is used in this scenario
                - Recommendations On : “Case”
                - Grounding Based on : Case Data such as “Subject” & “Description”
                - E.g. Email related to change in particulars such as ‘surname change’ (grounding based on record info)
            - Scenario 4
                - Parent tab : “Voice Call” or “Messaging Session”
                - Recommendations On : “Case”
                - Grounding Based on : “Voice Call” or “Messaging Session” - “Conversation Entries”
                - E.g. Messaging session for ‘Health Policy Changes’ issue (grounding based on parent in console)
            - Scenario 3 and Scenario 4 present recommendations on the same subject, but the sources differ—in essence, the context is either "self" or "parent."
- Ability to ship a template for the OOTB functionality that generates intents from the conversation and recommends actions (which is hardcoded in 254)
- Admins have the ability to configure labels within Assistive Actions, such as 'Show Topics' and 'Results,' allowing them to rename these labels based on different scenarios (with localisation support)
- Assistive action compatibility with the new unified catalog
    - Ability to re-use the set-up experience, vectorisation and search index creation and do semantic search in UI (this

might be a test only effort, to be validated with Engg)

Spill Over from 254

ABILITY TO CREATE SECTIONS FOR SERVICE ATTRIBUTES (SC)

STANDARD INVOCABLE ACTION ON FLOW FOR SUBMISSION CALL TO SERVICE AUTOMATION CONNECT API (SC)

DRAWER VIEW FOR CATEGORIES (FSC)

~~**ABILITY TO HAVE SPS AND UNIFIED CATALOG CO-EXIST (TO BE PICKED UP IN 254)**~~

CONVERT 'PRODUCT' LABELS FOR SERVICES (SC)

Product Code → Code
Product Description → Description
Product Family → Family
Product Name → Name
Product Record Type → Record Type
Product Type → Type

SHOW CUMULATIVE PRODUCTS/SERVICES WHEN WE ARE ON A PARENT CATEGORY (FSC)

ABILITY TO UPDATE THE SERVICE ATTRIBUTES POST REQUEST SUBMISSION (SC) -

CUSTOM ATTRIBUTE MAPPING TO PARENT CUSTOM ATTRIBUTE FOR VALIDATIONS. (SC)

ANCHOR DEFAULT FIELD MAPPING (SC)

Migration

Go-To-Market